A/PROF CHAMARA BASNAYAKE
MBBS, PhD, FRACP
Gastroenterologist & Endoscopist
PN 421926PK

FOCUS GASTROENTEROLOGY

13 May 2026

Leila Cheikh

Dear Leila Cheikh,

Re: Mr Peter Hill
DOB: 08/03/2000 Phone: 0408 938 054
Address: 459 Brunswick Road, BRUNSWICK, VIC, 3056
Email: hillpw988@gmail.com

Summary

- **Severe gastro-oesophageal reflux disease (GORD) with a recent episode of nocturnal chest pain.**
- **Increase in tobacco smoking with a slight reduction in weight.**
- **Placed on the public waiting list for surveillance gastroscopy.**
- **No action required by you.**

I had the pleasure of conducting a review with Peter Hill regarding the management of his gastro-oesophageal reflux disease. Thank you for referring him.

Peter described a recent episode of "crippling" nocturnal chest pain associated with rigours and shivering, which necessitated an emergency department presentation. The pain was eventually relieved by Gaviscon. While I suspect these symptoms are related to the severity of his reflux, they were clearly quite distressing for him. He remains on rabeprazole twice daily, noting that if he omits even a single dose, his symptoms return significantly. He also expressed concern that the medication's efficacy may be waning, as he is experiencing breakthrough dyspepsia and a sensation of "slow digestion" with richer meals.

Regarding his lifestyle, Peter has commenced an apprenticeship as an automotive electrician. He remains physically active with gym and sports, though he noted his cigarette smoking has increased recently. He also mentioned a slight decrease in his weight and occasional alcohol and cannabis use.

Impression and Plan

I have discussed the importance of a surveillance gastroscopy with Peter. Given the severity of his GORD and his current smoking status, there is a risk of the oesophageal lining undergoing metaplastic changes. I have placed him on the public hospital waiting list and requested a Friday list to accommodate his work schedule.

We discussed the long-term management of his hiatus hernia, including the option of a fundoplication. However, given his current level of physical activity and new apprenticeship, we have deferred surgical consideration for the time being. We also touched upon the potential long-term side effects of proton pump inhibitors (PPIs) such as osteoporosis; I have reassured him that this risk is considerably lower in male patients and is far outweighed by the risks of untreated reflux and smoking. I have provided him with a new six-month prescription for rabeprazole (20mg twice daily) with increased quantities.

All appointments and enquires
Suite 201, 100 Victoria Parade
East Melbourne VIC 3002
Ph: 03 9650 7917
Fax: 03 9650 7910
Pager: 03 9387 1000
Email: office@focusgastro.com.au

Endoscopy locations
Epworth Freemasons Day Proc. Centre
320 Victoria Pde, East Melbourne, 3002
Hobson Healthcare Sydenham
566 Melton Hwy, Sydenham, 3037
St Vincent's Private Hospital
59 Victoria Pde, Fitzroy, 3065

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Yours sincerely,

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